Chapter 39

Hovuhovu iobo – Digging out sea-sausages

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Figure 1: *Hovuhovu iobo* – Digging out sea-sausages

(1) ***Hovuhovu iobo***
(2) *O iobo a peha taba vaa tahii to ani-ani raara a ta Teapu.*
(3) *A taba bona na teitei batana paano kasuana ei komana tahii tea maa hum kakaamuru.*
(4) *Beara tau nao tea vagana iobo, eara toro dee o pusu hiovu, a sinaka ae a bonaa, eara re nao tea masi.*

Digging out sea-sausages
The sea-sausage is an animal of the sea that we Teop people eat.
This animal stays underground in the sea in places with white sand.

Before we go to catch sea-sausages, we must take a digging stick, a *sinaka* stick and a fishing basket, then we go to the reef.

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(5) *A bonaa he na vabibiinoo ni raara raparaara.* The fishing basket we carry on our side.



Figure 2: *Pusu hiovu* – Digging stick



Figure 3: *Sinaka*



(a) (b)

Figure 4: (a) *Bonaa vabibiinoo* – Fishing basket, (b) *Iobo* – Sea-sausage

(6) *Beara suguna teo hum hovuhovu iobo, eara repaa taneo tea tara rak-erake bata riori.* When we arrive at the place for digging out sea-sausages, we start searching for them.

(7)	*Beara tara a sii puhuku kakaamuru, eara repaa kona voen o iobo na tei nana.*	When we see a little heap of white sand, we know that there is a sea-sausage.
(8)	*Eara repaa hovu hopo ni nao a ta hiovu, beara hogo bata ni naora ta meha papa kuriraara.*	Then we stick the digging-stick inside (the heap), while we are pushing our other hand inside.
(9)	*Eove to kahi ato naona bono iobo bea ta hiovu gae hiava maa bona.*	It will get hold of the sea-sausage when the digging stick lifts it up.
(10)	*Beara mei rae tea vaobete e komana bonaa, eara toro pisin roho e, eara repaa vaobete mana e komana bonaa.*	Before we put it into the fishing basket, we must turn the sea-sausage inside out, then we eventually put it into the basket.
(11)	*Eara pasi paku bata koa vo nao nom teebona, ore antee komana beo manin vagana tean kavara ge ei beo puhana puhana maa.*	We will do it like this, until you don't feel like fishing anymore or the high tide has come in.
(12)	*A kiu vaa tea tatasu iobo na pakupaku vaha raara kasuana en vaan.*	The work of beating the sea-sausages, we do it again on the beach here in the village.
(13)	*Eara na tasu vatamee ae vamuraka ni rara o iobo, tea tabae o iobo o taba o torisi.*	We beat the sea-sausage flexible and soft, because the sea-sausage is a tough thing.
(14)	*Tea tatasu he eara na ibun rara amaa iobo tea sinaka, eara repaa tatasu riori bona ta hiovu.*	For the beating we put some sea-sausages on the *sinaka* stick, and then we beat them with the digging stick.
(15)	*Beo iobo bebeahu ae taveraha, eara repaa kona voen paa muraka vai vuru, eara repaa antee tea tasu.*	When the sea-sausage is long and flattened, we know that it is soft now so that we can stop beating it.



(a) (b)

Figure 5: (a) *Ibun iobo* – Stick with sea-sausages, (b) *Tatasu iobo* – Beating sea-sausages



(a) (b)

Figure 6: (a) *Geregerete* – Tearing off the upper part, (b) *Ahuhu* – Squeezing out the water

(16)	*Bea tatasu kavara, eara repaa geregerete riori ae ahuhu.*	When the beating is finished, we tear off the upper parts and squeeze the water out (of the sea-sausage).
(17)	*Be kavara eara repaa voosu vaan.*	When it is finished, we return home.
(18)	*Tea nahu nae he na paku vonaen:*	As for their cooking, it is done as follows:

(19)	*Eara na vaobete naora amaa iobo komana nahu.*	We put the sea-saugages into the pot.
(20)	*Eara repaa koma hopo nia ruene, tasu a ta hiihii ae o hiiruu.*	Then we pour water into it, pound a piece of ginger and basil leaves.
(21)	*Eara vaobete hopo e komana nahu eara repaa vaagonono.*	We put them into the pot and then we let the water boil.
(22)	*Beve mahaka, eara kou an vai e, a huun nae he na hiroo bata raara.*	When they are done, we eat them, while drinking their liquid.
(23)	*Evehee toro vaorete bata mi raara bona kaukau, muu, kavakava gea tapeako.*	But we must eat them together with sweet potatoes, taro, cooked bananas or manioc.